The response from the US chemical industry was predictable. At first, they tried to sue Carson, her publishers, and *The New Yorker*—which had published a serialization of the book. However, Carson was prepared for this kind of response. She knew the book would be controversial and seen as threatening by the chemical industry. Therefore, as well as meticulously tracking and recording her research—which had been gained from government bodies, her contacts in research institutions, and other reputable sources—she also had the manuscript reviewed by scientists and experts.

When suing Carson did not work, the chemical companies launched a campaign to bring her into disrepute, stooping to personal attacks such as depicting Carson as a "hysterical" cat-loving woman, who was ill-equipped to write such a book. The smear campaign backfired, merely increasing the sales of *Silent Spring*.

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**"A spray as indiscriminate as DDT can upset the economy of nature… Ninety percent of all insects are good, and if they are killed, things go out of kilter right away."**

**Edwin Way Teale**

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